Post & Core: Fibre Post

/dental-care/prosthodontic-care/fibre-post-core

Restoring Damaged Teeth with a Natural-Looking Foundation

When a tooth has been severely damaged by decay or fracture, there may not be enough natural tooth structure left to support a crown. After root canal treatment, a fibre post and core may be recommended to help retain the core build-up and provide a foundation for the final restoration.

Fibre posts are commonly made from glass fibres embedded in resin. Their properties differ from metal posts, and they may be considered when restoring a suitable root-treated tooth.

What Is a Fibre Post & Core?

A fibre post and core restoration consists of three parts:

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Fibre Post

A small, fibre-reinforced post placed inside the prepared root canal to help retain the core.

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Core Build-Up

A restorative material used to rebuild the missing portion of the tooth.

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Final Crown

A custom-made covering that may be placed over the restored tooth to help protect it and restore its shape and function.

A post is primarily used to retain the core when insufficient tooth structure remains. It does not automatically strengthen the root, and not every root canal-treated tooth requires one.

When Might a Fibre Post Be Recommended?

A fibre post may be considered when a root canal-treated tooth has lost a significant amount of its natural structure.

Possible situations include:

- Extensive tooth decay or structural damage

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- A fractured or weakened upper portion of the tooth

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- Insufficient remaining tooth structure to retain a core

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- A tooth that requires a crown after root canal treatment

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The dentist will assess the remaining tooth structure, root condition, bite and expected restoration before deciding whether a fibre post is appropriate.

How Is the Fibre Post Placed?

The procedure is planned to preserve as much healthy tooth structure as possible.

1. Tooth Assessment

The dentist examines the tooth and may take an X-ray to assess the root and previous root canal treatment.

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2. Fibre Post Placement

When appropriate, the canal space is prepared conservatively and the fibre post is secured using a suitable bonding and cementation technique.

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3. Core Build-Up and Crown

The missing tooth structure is rebuilt. A suitable final crown may then be planned to restore the tooth's function and appearance.

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Fibre Post vs Metal Post: What Is the Difference?

Both fibre and metal posts may be used to retain a core in selected root canal-treated teeth. The right choice depends on the tooth and the planned restoration.

- Fibre post: Has properties that can be closer to dentine in flexibility and may offer aesthetic advantages in certain restorations.
- Metal post: Has different mechanical properties and may be appropriate in selected clinical situations.
- Important consideration: Neither option is automatically best for every tooth. The remaining root and tooth structure are central to treatment planning.

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Before & After: Rebuilding the Tooth

Before Image

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After Image

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A fibre post and core may help retain a restoration when a tooth has lost substantial structure. The long-term outcome depends on root health, the amount of remaining tooth structure, bite forces and the quality of the final restoration.

Caring for Your Restored Tooth

- Brush twice daily and clean between your teeth.

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- Follow your dentist's instructions while waiting for the final crown.

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- Avoid biting hard objects with a temporary restoration.

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- Attend regular dental check-ups.

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- Seek dental advice if the tooth becomes painful or the restoration feels loose.

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is a fibre post in dentistry?

A fibre post is a fibre-reinforced post placed inside a prepared root canal to help retain the core restoration when insufficient natural tooth structure remains.

2. Is a fibre post better than a metal post?

Not in every case. Fibre and metal posts have different properties, and the choice depends on the remaining tooth structure, root condition and planned restoration.

3. Does every root canal-treated tooth need a fibre post?

No. A post is considered only when needed to retain the core. Some teeth can be restored without a post.

4. Is fibre post placement painful?

The procedure is carried out using appropriate pain-control measures. Your dentist will explain what to expect based on your tooth's condition.

5. Will I need a crown after a fibre post?

A crown may be recommended to protect and restore a significantly damaged tooth. The final decision depends on the tooth and the clinical assessment.

6. How long does a fibre post last?

There is no fixed lifespan. The outcome depends on the tooth's condition, the restoration, bite forces and ongoing oral care.

7. Can a fibre post-treated tooth fracture?

Yes. A post cannot eliminate the risk of root or tooth fracture. Careful case selection, conservative preparation and an appropriate final restoration are important.

Restore Your Tooth with Personalised Care at Jerush

A damaged tooth may still be suitable for restoration when its root and remaining structure can support treatment. At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, our dental team evaluates each case and explains the available restorative options.

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Book a dental consultation with Jerush to explore suitable treatment options for your tooth.